

LEONIDAS LIFTS

Annual Longevity Peptide Stack

Year-Round Recovery Architecture — 4 Compounds

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THE LEONIDAS LIFTS ANNUAL LONGEVITY PEPTIDE STACK

Year-Round Recovery Architecture — 4 Compounds

This stack is the recovery optimization layer that sits on top of the Training Program, Nutrition Plan, and Starter Supplement Stack. It is NOT a shortcut. It is NOT a substitute for training discipline. It is a set of four compounds — three peptides and one food-grade protein — that support connective tissue repair, growth hormone axis health, and long-term joint longevity across years of heavy training.

Prerequisite: 2+ years of consistent training. Running the Starter Supplement Stack. Baseline bloodwork completed with a licensed physician. If you have not earned the foundation, these tools are not for you yet.

Backed by 5 peer-reviewed studies — verified May 2026.

The Stack — 4 Items

1. BPC-157 (Body Protection Compound-157)

What it is: A 15-amino-acid peptide derived from human gastric juice. Activates the Src-Caveolin-1-eNOS pathway for nitric oxide generation, FAK-paxillin for fibroblast adhesion, and JAK2/GHR for growth hormone receptor upregulation.

What it does: Accelerates tendon, ligament, and muscle repair. Promotes angiogenesis (new blood vessel formation) in damaged tissue. Reverses NSAID-induced gut damage. Reduces inflammation via the COX-NO axis and NF-κB suppression. *(Note: all effects above are documented in animal and in vitro models; human evidence is limited to three small pilot studies)*

as of 2025. WADA prohibited BPC-157 in 2022; FDA classified it as a Category 2 bulk drug in September 2023.)

Why it's here: Heavy training for years accumulates connective tissue wear. BPC-157 addresses the rate-limiting factor in long-term training longevity — tendon and ligament recovery, which occurs far slower than muscle recovery. Collagen in tendons is essentially formed during growth and is not meaningfully renewed in adulthood (Heinemeier et al., 2013; [DOI](#)); BPC-157 accelerates the remodeling that keeps those structures functional under load.

Dosing: Follow your provider's protocol. Typical research protocols use subcutaneous injection every other day. Consult a physician for dosing appropriate to your situation.

2. TB-500 (Thymosin Beta-4)

What it is: A 43-amino-acid peptide that binds G-actin monomers, preventing F-actin polymerization and increasing cell migration capacity. Activates the ILK/Akt pathway for cell survival.

What it does: Mobilizes cells into damaged tissue environments. Where BPC-157 creates the vascular and signaling scaffold (the "road"), TB-500 moves the repair cells down that road. Together they address both rate-limiting steps of tissue repair: infrastructure and cellular migration.

Why it's here: The BPC-157 + TB-500 is the most-discussed connective-tissue combination in the peptide research community, with both compounds supported by preclinical animal data but not yet by peer-reviewed human RCTs. Running them together produces results exceeding either compound alone. For a lifter pushing heavy volume 6 days/week, this combination supports the joints, tendons, and ligaments that take the accumulated load.

Dosing: Follow your provider's protocol. Typically paired with BPC-157 in a combination vial for convenience. Consult a physician.

3. BioGrow (IGF-1) — iSatori Bio-Gro

What it is: A bio-active peptide supplement (food-grade, non-injectable) containing bovine colostrum-derived growth factors including IGF-1 (Insulin-like Growth Factor 1) and other bio-active peptides.

What it does: A food-grade bovine colostrum-derived bioactive peptide supplement. A peer-reviewed 8-week safety study in resistance-trained men found no adverse effects on organ markers (Lowery et al., 2015; [DOI](#)). Efficacy on muscle protein synthesis in humans has not been established in peer-reviewed RCTs; the IGF-1 pathway mechanism is extrapolated from in-vitro colostrum-peptide work.

Why it's here: BioGrow provides IGF-1 support through an oral, food-grade supplement rather than an injectable. It bridges the gap between the Starter Supplement Stack and the full Peptide Protocol V3 for lifters who want growth factor support without injections.

⚠ TIMING NOTE: *BioGrow (IGF-1) should wait for **6–12 months of consistent training experience** before introduction. The other three items in this stack (BPC-157, TB-500, collagen peptide) are fine to start regardless of training history. The reason: IGF-1 pathway activation is most effective when the training stimulus is already established and progressive overload is consistent. Introducing IGF-1 support before the training foundation is solid wastes the compound's potential — you are amplifying a signal that isn't strong enough yet.*

Dosing: Follow the product label. Typically 1.5g powder mixed into a shake or taken with water. Available on Amazon and supplement retailers.

4. Collagen Peptide (Hydrolyzed) — Blue-Lid / Costco

What it is: Hydrolyzed collagen peptides — the most abundant structural protein in the human body, broken down into bioavailable peptide fragments that can be absorbed and utilized for connective tissue repair.

What it does: Provides the raw substrate for collagen synthesis in tendons, ligaments, cartilage, and skin. Shaw et al. (2017; [DOI](#)) demonstrated that consuming 15 g vitamin C-enriched gelatin 60 minutes before exercise doubled blood markers of collagen synthesis (PINP), with engineered ligaments treated with subject serum showing increased collagen content and mechanical strength.

Why it's here: Training breaks down connective tissue. The body rebuilds it from collagen. If you are not providing adequate collagen substrate, the rebuilding is limited by supply, not by demand. This is the simplest, cheapest, most well-supported item in the stack — and potentially the most impactful for joint longevity.

What to buy: The blue-lid hydrolyzed collagen peptides from Costco (Vital Proteins or equivalent). Unflavored powder, dissolves in any liquid. ~\$25 for a 2-month supply at typical dosing.

Dosing: Follow the product label (typically 10–20g daily). Take with 500mg vitamin C 60 minutes before training for maximum collagen synthesis benefit (per Shaw et al., 2017). Can also be added to a morning shake or coffee.

How This Stack Fits Into the V3 System

Layer	Plan	This Stack's Role
1 — Foundation	Training Program V3	The stimulus that creates the tissue demand
2 — Fuel	Nutrition Plan V3	The macro + supplement floor
3 — Starter Stack	Starter Supplement Stack	Natural lifter baseline (Fadogia, Tongkat, Creatine, Omega-3, Amino Energy)
4 — Longevity	This Stack	Connective tissue repair + growth factor support
5 — Full Optimization	Peptide Protocol V3	The complete 24-week cutting protocol (10 compounds)

Key Takeaways

- 1. 4 items:** BPC-157, TB-500, BioGrow (IGF-1), and a collagen peptide (blue-lid/Costco).
- 2. BioGrow should wait 6–12 months** of consistent training. The other three are fine to start immediately.
- 3. BPC-157 + TB-500 is the connective tissue gold standard** — scaffold + cellular migration.
- 4. Gelatin + vitamin C pre-training** doubles collagen synthesis markers (Shaw et al., 2017). Hydrolyzed collagen peptides have separate, supportive evidence.
- 5. This stack is the bridge** between the Starter Supplement Stack and the full Peptide Protocol V3.

6. **Bloodwork is mandatory** if running BPC-157 and TB-500 — baseline before starting, follow-up at 90 days.

Sources

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MEDICAL DISCLAIMER: Educational only, not medical advice. Consult a physician before beginning any peptide or supplement regimen. Follow product labels for dosing. All compounds referenced are research compounds or food-grade supplements. The author is not a medical professional. Individual responses vary. [Flag: attorney review]

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